

On the house alone, SoHo is cheaper. Transport is the whole story.

Separating the two makes it clear. **SoHo’s house costs are R580 a month lower** — its rent already covers sanitation, refuse and security, and its electricity is well under Petra Nera’s. Petra Nera wins overall only because nobody Ubers to church.

HOUSE COSTS	TRANSPORT	NET	THE OTHER PERSON
–R580	+R1,300	R720	–R290
SoHo cheaper per month	SoHo dearer — all of it the CRC run	Petra Nera ahead · R8,690 a year	Better off at SoHo, per month

TABLE 1

House costs only

Everything you pay to live there. No transport.

MONTHLY HOUSE COSTS		
LINE ITEM	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800
Rent	R9,000	R8,800
Sanitation / sewerage	unknown — ask	included in rent
Refuse & security	unknown — ask	included in rent
Electricity Petra Nera: your figure · SoHo: derived, Table 4	R1,000	R620
Water SoHo: derived, Table 4	R150	R150
Internet 50 Mbps uncapped — see Table 4b	R550	R550
House total	R10,700	R10,120
Per person	R5,350	R5,060
Difference	SoHo cheaper by R580 a month — R6,960 a year	

WHY SOHO’S HOUSE IS CHEAPER

Two reasons, both structural. **The R8,800 covers sanitation, refuse and security**, which the other SoHo unit bills at R1,400 on top. And **electricity runs R380 lower** because the geyser sits on the body corporate’s account and the hobs are gas — Petra Nera heats its own water. Rent is nearly identical; everything under it is not.

TABLE 2

Transport, calculated separately

One person travels to CRC. Wits is two Wednesdays together in one car, two Wednesdays separately in two.

MONTHLY UBER — 4.33 WEEKS, R100 PER ROUND TRIP TO CRC, R190 TO WITS			
TRIP	CARS × DAYS	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800
CRC — one person Mon, Tue, Thu	1 × 13	R0 — 6 min walk	R1,300
Wits — together 2 Wednesdays, one car, fare split	1 × 2.17	R411	R411
Wits — separately 2 Wednesdays, one car each	2 × 2.17	R823	R823
Wits subtotal		R1,234	R1,234
Transport total	R1,234	R2,534	
Difference		SoHo dearer by R1,300 — entirely the CRC run	

WHO PAYS IT

The Wits cost is **R617 each** at both places — R206 for the two shared Wednesdays, R411 for the two you travel separately. Identical either way.

The CRC R1,300 falls on **one person**. That is the entire difference between the two flats, carried by whoever makes the church run.

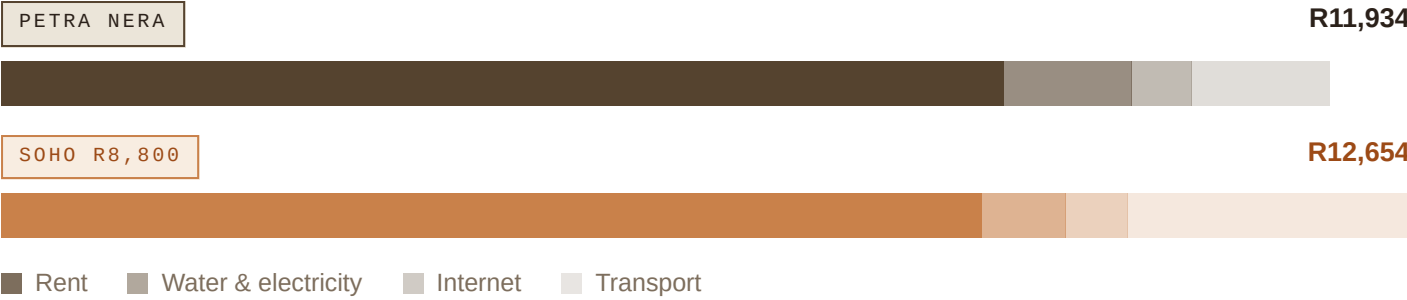
A NOTE ON THE MONTH

These use **4.33 weeks** — the true yearly average, not a 4-week month. Your “two together, two apart” pattern is applied as a 50/50 split, so 2.17 Wednesdays each way. A clean 4-Wednesday month would read R380 shared and R760 separate, about 8% lower than shown.

TABLE 3
Combined, and who pays what

HOUSE PLUS TRANSPORT		
	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800
House — Table 1	R10,700	R10,120
Transport — Table 2	R1,234	R2,534
Monthly total	R11,934	R12,654
Gap	Petra Nera ahead by R720 a month — R8,690 a year	

PER PERSON — CRC BORNE BY THE TRAVELLER, HOUSE AND WITS SPLIT		
	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800
House, halved	R5,350	R5,060
Wits, per person	R617	R617
CRC — traveller only	R0	R1,300
The CRC traveller pays	R5,967	R6,977
The other person pays	R5,967	R5,677



THE SPLIT IS LOPSIDED

The **non-CRC person is R290 a month better off at SoHo** — R5,677 against R5,967. The CRC traveller is R1,010 worse off. So SoHo is not more expensive for the household so much as more expensive *for one of you*, and cheaper for the other. Worth settling how you would handle that before signing either lease.

TABLE 4

SoHo prepaid water and electricity

Built from the published 2026/27 tariffs and the complex’s confirmed fittings. Still an estimate — no tenant figure is published anywhere.

ELECTRICITY — R620		WATER — R150	
STEP	VALUE	STEP	VALUE
City Power 2026/27 prepaid, block 1	290.46 c/kWh	Johannesburg Water 2026/27, 0–6 kL	free
0–350 kWh, council-approved March 2026	excl VAT	6–10 kL	R16.45/kL
Including VAT	R3.34/kWh	10–15 kL	R20.82/kL
Two-person flat, fully electric	300–450 kWh	Two people, flat, no garden	4–7 kL
Less geyser — central here	–30 to 40%	If the free 6 kL reaches your meter	~R0 – R20
Less hob — gas here	–10%	If the scheme reconciles in bulk	~R125 – R250
Less lighting — LED here	–3%	free allowance spread over ~400 units	
Remaining load	140–235 kWh	Demand-management levy	~R108
fridge, washer, oven, kettle, electronics, standby		may sit on the scheme’s account	
Range	R468 – R785	Range	R50 – R300
Estimate used — 185 kWh	R620	Estimate used	R150

THE ONE QUESTION THAT WOULD SETTLE WATER

SoHo bills water through **STSS prepaid sub-metering**, so the rate you pay is set by how the body corporate passes on Johannesburg Water’s stepped tariff. If it passes the free first 6 kL through per unit, two people would pay **almost nothing**. If it reconciles the whole scheme in bulk, you pay for every kilolitre. That is the difference between R20 and R250 a month — ask what the STSS rate per kilolitre is.

Electricity is firmer: the tariff is published, the fittings are confirmed, and Petra Nera’s actual R1,000 for a larger flat heating its own water sits exactly where this model predicts. **R620 is sound to within about R150 either way.**

TABLE 4B

Fibre at SoHo

The complex is fibre-ready and the developer specced fibre in, so there is no trenching — only an activation. That is why installation is normally free.

UNCAPPED FIBRE — 2026 MARKET RATES, BROADACRES		
SPEED	MONTHLY	SUITS
10–20 Mbps	R279 – R339	One person, light use. Tight for two on video calls
25–30 Mbps	R389 – R450	Two people, streaming and browsing
50 Mbps	R500 – R600	Two people, Wits work, simultaneous calls and streaming — used here
100 Mbps	R700 – R800	More than two people need
Installation	R0	Free on virtually every Openserve and Vumatel package via Webafrika, Afrihost and RSAWEB — normally worth R1,500–R2,800
Router	R0	Included on most packages. Wi-Fi 6 is standard above R699

REVISED DOWN FROM R800

The earlier R800 assumed a 100 Mbps line and some installation cost. Neither is right for you: **50 Mbps at about R550 is ample for two people**, and installation on a fibre-ready building is free. That is **R250 a month off both flats** — the gap between them is unchanged, but both totals come down.

WHAT I COULD NOT CONFIRM

Which network actually serves 4 Poplar Avenue. Openserve covers Broadacres and Fourways, and Vumatel and Frogfoot are both active nearby — but coverage in Johannesburg changes street by street, and the checkers need the exact address entered live. Run “4 Poplar Avenue, Broadacres” through Webafrica or Afrihost before you budget.

Also ask the agent whether the complex has a **bulk deal with one ISP**. Some do, which can be cheaper — or can lock you out of shopping around.

TABLES 5 AND 6

Move-in cash and year one

TABLE 5 — CASH TO MOVE IN

ITEM	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800
Deposit refundable	R9,000	R9,000
First month's rent	R9,000	R8,800
Admin / lease initiation	R2,000 above market	~R1,250
Credit check	included?	~R300
Meter activation, tags	~R500	~R500
Fibre install + router	R0 – 1,800	R0 – 1,800
Moving	R3,000 – 6,000	R3,000 – 6,000
Cash needed	R23,500 – 28,300	R22,850 – 27,650

TABLE 6 — YEAR ONE

	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800
Twelve months of running cost	R143,208	R151,848
Non-refundable once-offs	~R7,400	~R7,450
Year-one cash out	~R150,600	~R159,300
Plus deposit held	R9,000	R9,000
Difference		R8,690 — R4,345 each

TABLE 7

What would change the answer

At R720 apart, three scenarios level it or reverse it.

EACH SCENARIO ON ITS OWN			
IF...	PETRA NERA	SOHO	GAP
Base case — as tabled	R11,934	R12,654	R720
SoHo electricity is 235 kWh, not 185	R11,934	R12,819	R885
SoHo water is R300	R11,934	R12,804	R870
SoHo water is R50 — free 6 kL passed through	R11,934	R12,554	R620
SoHo electricity is 140 kWh	R11,934	R12,504	R570
Petra Nera electricity is R1,300	R12,234	R12,654	R420
Petra Nera bills sanitation and refuse at R700	R12,634	R12,654	R20 level
Petra Nera bills them at R1,400 what the other SoHo unit charges	R13,334	R12,654	—R680 — SoHo cheaper
Either of you joins a gym R650 + R1,170 Uber at Petra Nera; free on site at SoHo	R13,754	R12,654	—R1,100 — SoHo cheaper

STILL ONE QUESTION OUTSTANDING

SoHo has confirmed what its rent covers. **Petra Nera has not.** If its R1,150 excludes sanitation and refuse the way SoHo's R9,500 unit does, the R720 becomes a R680 deficit and SoHo wins. That single answer is worth more than every other line on this page.

TABLE 8

Questions to ask

PETRA NERA	SOHO JUNCTION R8,800
1. Does the R1,150 cover sanitation, sewerage and refuse, or are those billed on top? Worth R680 either way — this decides it. 2. If billed separately, what did they come to last month? 3. Can we see a recent utility bill, so the R1,150 is confirmed rather than quoted? 4. What does the R2,000 admin fee cover, and is it negotiable? Market is R950–R1,500. 5. What is the annual escalation percentage? 6. Security setup — guard, access control, CCTV, perimeter? 7. How many parking bays, covered or allocated? 8. Backup power and water storage during outages? 9. Age of geyser, plumbing and roof — who pays for repairs? 10. Will the landlord contribute to repainting? 11. Is the walking route to CRC lit at night? 12. Availability, and is R9,000 held for a 12-month lease?	1. Get the levy inclusion written into the lease — that sanitation, refuse and security are covered by the R8,800 and cannot be billed separately later. 2. Which fibre network serves the building — Openserve, Vumatel or Frogfoot? Does the complex have a bulk ISP deal? 3. What is the STSS rate per kilolitre for water? The difference between the free 6 kL being passed through or not is R20 against R250 a month. 4. What does a two-bed here actually spend on prepaid electricity? Ask a current tenant or the estate manager. 5. What is the floor size? The other 2-bed 2-bath in the complex is 62 m². 6. If the body corporate raises the levies mid-lease, who absorbs it? 7. Is the carport allocated, and can a second bay be rented? At what cost? 8. What is the annual escalation percentage? 9. Any special levies planned? Can we see the last two AGM minutes? 10. Total once-off cost — admin, credit checks for two, tags, meter activation? 11. Deposit interest arrangement, and which account? 12. Generator or inverter for load-shedding, and water tanks for outages? 13. Early-cancellation penalty — can it be capped in writing?

TABLE 9

Assumptions

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	SOURCE
Occupancy	Two people	Third room at Petra Nera used as a study, not let
Gym	None	No membership either side. See the last row of Table 7
CRC travel	One person, 13 round trips	Mon, Tue, Thu × 4.33 weeks. Uber prices the trip, not the seat
Wits travel	2.17 shared + 2.17 separate	Your pattern — two Wednesdays together, two apart — over 4.33 Wednesdays
Uber to CRC	R50 each way	Your figure
Uber to Wits	~R95 each way	Your figure
Internet	R550/month	50 Mbps uncapped on Openserve or Vumatel. Installation free on most packages. Range R339–R800 — see Table 4b
SoHo levies	R0 — in the rent	Confirmed with the agent: R8,800 covers sanitation, refuse and security
SoHo electricity	R620	City Power block 1 at R3.34/kWh incl VAT × 185 kWh. Range R468–R785
SoHo water	R150	Johannesburg Water 2026/27 stepped tariff, STSS sub-metered. Range R50–R300
SoHo floor size	Unknown	Not stated. The other 2-bed 2-bath is 62 m²
Petra Nera electricity / water	R1,000 / R150	Your figures
Petra Nera sanitation & refuse	Unknown	The largest remaining uncertainty — worth up to R1,400
Petra Nera deposit & admin	R9,000 + R2,000	Your figures
Weeks per month	4.33	52 ÷ 12 — the yearly average

SOURCES

- [Property24 — SoHo Junction R8,800](#) · [SoHo Junction R9,500](#) — the R9,500 listing itemises the R900 sanitation and R500 refuse the R8,800 unit includes
- [City Power 2026/27 tariffs](#) — Residential Prepaid High block 1 (0–350 kWh) at 290.46 c/kWh excl VAT, council-approved March 2026, effective 1 July 2026
- [Johannesburg Water 2026/27 approved tariffs](#) · [tariff page](#) — first 6 kL free, R16.45/kL to 10 kL, R20.82/kL to 15 kL; water up 12.5%, sanitation up 11%
- [OCC Property — SoHo Junction developer specification](#) — gas hobs, central water heating, low-energy lights; Activity Centre with gym, sauna, steam room and business centre
- [Water meters in sectional title schemes](#) — bulk-metered schemes are billed on an inclining block tariff and reconciled per unit by the body corporate
- [CRC Johannesburg](#) — cnr Witkoppen & Riverbend Road, Fourways